S(ituation) T(asks) A(ction) R(esults)

1. **Situation:** I had a situation where we had a group of system analysts who required a production environment to be stable both with code and data even though they had a user acceptance testing environment which seemingly was exactly what they were asking for. This environment was actually the standard test environment for developers and engineers used to test their changes on a day to day basis for over 130 different .NET applications. The development manager who required this environment so normal operations wouldn't be impeded.

   Tasks: I broke the problem down into tasks to more easily learn the needs of both groups.

   1. I started with defining what the system analysts referred to as production.
   2. This identified the team needing an environment to test their production configurations with static data to properly assess whether the configurations were accurate.
   3. I looked at alternative environments for this to occur without impeding the development team's daily usage of the test environment, which included weekly data refreshes and on the data side, new stored procedures and database schema changes.
   4. Interfaced with the operations team to see if there were available resources for which I could utilize for either team if needed.

   Action:

   1. I organized a series of meetings for managers of both teams to meet and see if there were opportunities to leverage the existing infrastructure and workflow.
   2. The meetings were useful in that we identified there were no consistencies available in the current workflow and environment for which both could have their desired outcomes.
   3. I analyzed the current development workflow which included automated deployments to the test environment which is what was causing the daily inconsistencies. These occurred as designed because of a newly implemented Microsoft flow branching strategy implemented as part of a standardization project across departments.
   4. I met a 2nd time with the managers and proposed a workaround which was to implement a new Test environment for the development group and to rename the existing Test environment to 'SA Test' and disconnect all code and database deployments to that environment.

   Result:

   1. The development manager wasn't excited about this option but was willing to acquiesce, as the new environment had improvements over the existing test environment which were significant.

   2. The System Analyst manager was pleased with the ability to continue critical testing without interruption.

2. **Describe a major failure in your career and what you learned from the experience.**

   (S) As a web hosted operations administrator, I was faced with being identified as someone who was not invested or motivated in my
   responsibilities to support legacy software products on a day to day basis.

   (T) The challenge was that I was also being given new devOps/cloud-based projects that included new technology and processes to learn which were extremely motivating.

   (A) I didn't take that criticism seriously and made excuses as to why it was unwarranted. I neglected to take stock of my performance in the identified areas and act on them.

   (R) I was let go because of it.

    1. **Be humble. You are never irreplaceable.** I was displaying my ego, but I was also refusing to do what I was asked to do when hired. I failed the most basic task which was to do a good job and help the team be successful.
    2. **Don't complicate your job**. New technology and skills are ALWAYS going to be there to learn. Do what you were hired to do over and above expectations. Anything extra is a great bonus.
    3. **Understand what's expected of you.** I should have acknowledged my shortcomings and communicated a plan to fix the issues with those above me. I should have asked how that plan was progressing.

3. **Tell me of a time you had a disagreement with a co-worker and how you dealt with it:**

   (S) Idaho dept of Commerce - Exchange server storage capacity was close to full and there were no mailbox limits in place. No money was available in the budget to expand the disk space. If the server ran out of server space, the IP phone system would fail.

   (T) I researched

    1. State requirements for keeping communications
    2. Staff mailbox practices
    3. Industry standards for mailbox size.
    4. Obtained a list of the top 20 largest mailboxes so I could talk to those individuals.

   (A) I sent out an email detailing what could be done to reduce mailbox size and why it was important. One of the departments did not agree and wanted no restrictions imposed and requested a separate Exchange server. I met with the administrator of that department several times to explain the situation. No positive outcome could be reached between us, so I escalated the issue to the Fiscal manager.

   (R) Mailbox size requirements were put in place, but we tried to accommodate the specific manager’s department by setting a larger mailbox limit to help. The mailboxes that were too large were then dealt with on a case by case basis.

4. **Tell me about a time when you were under a large amount of pressure and how you dealt with it**

   (S) Tasked with developing installers for multiple vendors in Canada in a limited timeframe and no backup resources. Because of Canadian healthcare laws, HW could not host CA client web sites.

   (T) Custom IIS web sites needed to be configured, each with a different configuration for multiple CA insurance customers.

   (A) Intense research online, started right away even though I wasn't sure I was on the right path.

   (R) I was able to create intricate installers that automated the creation of IIS web sites with separate app pools and localized artifacts in the limited amount of time given to me.

5. **Talk about a time where you had to deal with, what you thought, were unreasonable customer expectations**

   (S) Having to sit in large HP-Americas meetings muted to tell my HP manager what to say regarding our support processes for a large-scale phone support consolidation to HP Roseville.
   (T) No task was required as I felt that what was being asked was not in my purview.
   (A) I communicated my discomfort regarding the situation and when I was still requested to do it, I talked with my direct contract manager on how to best handle it.
   (R) I was only required to perform this function once. I was not asked to do it again, however the level of relationship significantly changed for the worse.

6. **Where you had to lead a process improvement team:** ***WTC Migration to Deskside***

(S) Working as a senior IT engineer for a managed service contractor at HP-Boise, cost-cutting measures from HP IT management and therefore a significant priority. I was given a project to migrate the remote customized IT support process (WTC's) to a common deskside support mode. This change affected 10 buildings and approximately 25 IT support technicians.

(T) Development of phone tree and ticketing queues, Rollout Plan with a prioritization of all Business Units, AD group / user permission testing and implementation

(A) Loose description of actions: Proactive email communications, staged rollout of support, handling support resource morale, status updates to IT management.

(R) All but 1 BU rolled over. 2 business units were extremely uncomfortable so a trial period was instated for the 2 BU's to prove out the new processes.

7. **Where you had an outcome that was better than expected:** ***Network Printer Installer***

(S) HP-IT wanted a better method to streamline printer setups for new employees.

(T) The process would need to eliminate user interaction with the print driver and preferably limit helpdesk calls.

(A) Built a custom web application in ASP that enabled users to find multi-function printers based on their location and then install the proper printer drivers and set that printer as their default printer.

(R) This was a great success and ended up being rolled up into HP's WebJetAdmin software.

8. **Where the outcome was positive:** ***A. Deletinator***

(S) The video solutions team with their custom developed classroom capture system (named

Matterhorn), had no way to remove previously captured classroom lectures thus filling up the Linux based server storage file system.

(T) Needed a solution to interface with BSU's Matterhorn system, both their API's and the RHEL file system. Would require a great deal of communication with the software vendor who provided the API's and was based in Switzerland and Israel, as well as the video team for testing. Permissions for RHEL file server service account access, obtaining API documentation via BaseCamp.

(A) Created a .Net C# MVC Bootstrap web application that provided a front end so that the team could identify a unique video with its accompanying artifacts (audio, video, annotations, pdf's, etc.). Then hooking into RESTful API's, delete that set of artifacts from the file system.

(R) System was completed and worked, giving the video team a usable tool. Shortly after, the software vendor decided that a delete function was a primary component they needed so they created their own. (Quite the coincidence).

9. A situation where you had competing priorities

10. A time where you had to deal with a difficult co-worker